squash palabok

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A spin on a Filipino classic, pancit palabok. Umami packed and seasonal. Save your scraps for the stock to get more flavor. I added Japanese ingredients and it came out pretty good! I added squash puree to it to give it that lusciousness without adding flour and while also staying seasonal. Any squash works in this recipe but ideally I would choose kabocha squash. I used honey nut in the video and it was a little too sweet but still good. I chose udon noodles because I like the chew but you can use the traditional rice noodles to keep it gluten free, if you'd like. My favorite part of the dish is all the toppings. I added crushed chicharrones, bonito, scallions, and fried garlic. Lots of different textures and flavors.

To make this recipe with less dishes and faster you can buy canned pumpkin puree and chicken stock.

TIKTOK VIDEO

Recipe: serves 2

Shrimp squash stock

- 3 quarts water
- Squash scraps (skins too)
- Shrimp shells
- 1 sheet kombu
- 1 Tbsp annato seeds
- any allium scrap works in this as well.

1. Combine all ingredients in pot and bring to simmer.
2. Simmer for about 20 minutes. Strain and set aside.

Squash shrimp gravy

- 8 oz. ground pork
- 1/2 cup squash puree
- 2 cups shrimp squash stock
- 2 Tbsp fish sauce
- Juice of 1 lemon
- Salt and pepper, to taste

1. Render pork in pan until golden brown. About 4 minutes.
2. Add squash puree and stock. Mix until combined and bring to boil.
3. Cook until the sauce thickens to a gravy consistency, about 8-10 minutes. If too thick, add more stock or water.
4. Season with fish sauce, lemon juice and black pepper.

Palabok:

- 1 lb. udon
- 2 cups shrimp squash gravy
- 6 pieces of shrimp, poached
- 2 hard boiled eggs, sliced, for topping
- 3 scallions, sliced, for topping
- Crushed chicharrones, for topping
- Bonito flakes, for topping
- Fried garlic, for topping
- Lemon wedge, for garnish

1. Warm udon noodles in boiling water and drain of excess liquid.
2. Place noodles in bowl, pour gravy over noodles and top with all the toppings.
3. Squeeze that lemon wedge over the top and enjoy!

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